

A woman with dark hair tied back is sitting on a light-colored, textured armchair. She is wearing a dark-colored t-shirt and is gesturing with both hands as if in conversation. The room is filled with various green plants, including a large pothos plant in the foreground and several other leafy plants in the background. A small table in front of her holds a smartphone and a can. A backpack is visible on the floor to the right. The entire scene is overlaid with a semi-transparent green filter.

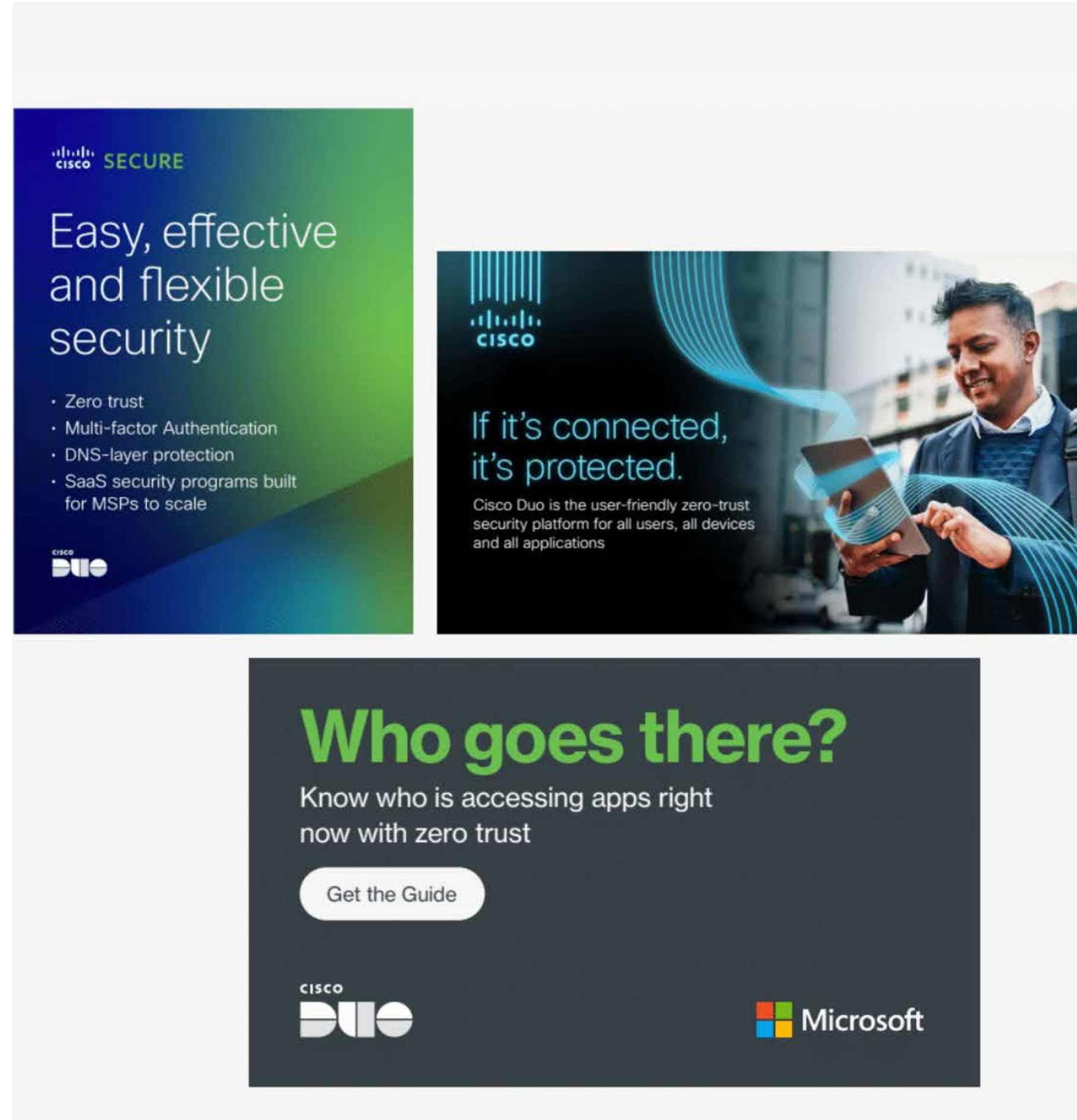
PROJECT CASE STUDY

Cisco Secure Customer Storytelling

Evan Gonzalez • Video Production / Customer Storytelling / Scalable Creative Systems

THE BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Turning individual product stories into a stronger Cisco Secure story



Cisco had unified several acquired security products under Cisco Secure, but individual product identities remained strong in the market.

Customers could understand products like Duo independently without always seeing how the broader security portfolio worked together.

The creative challenge: move beyond traditional B2B case studies and create human customer films that made complex security technology easier to understand and more compelling to watch.



MY ROLE

I led the creative system around the storytelling – from strategy through execution.

<i>Video & Production Leadership</i>	<i>Partners</i>
Led customer-story strategy and production approach Built the interview framework around business priorities and human stories Led the video team, production model, budgets, schedules, and delivery roadmap Directed agency and production partners Established the visual and production standard across the series Stayed hands-on through editing and cross-channel adaptation Led scripting and narrative development for supporting explainers	Product Marketing Customer Advocacy Demand Generation Events and Sales Cisco Brand Technical SMEs Agencies & production partners



THE CREATIVE STRATEGY

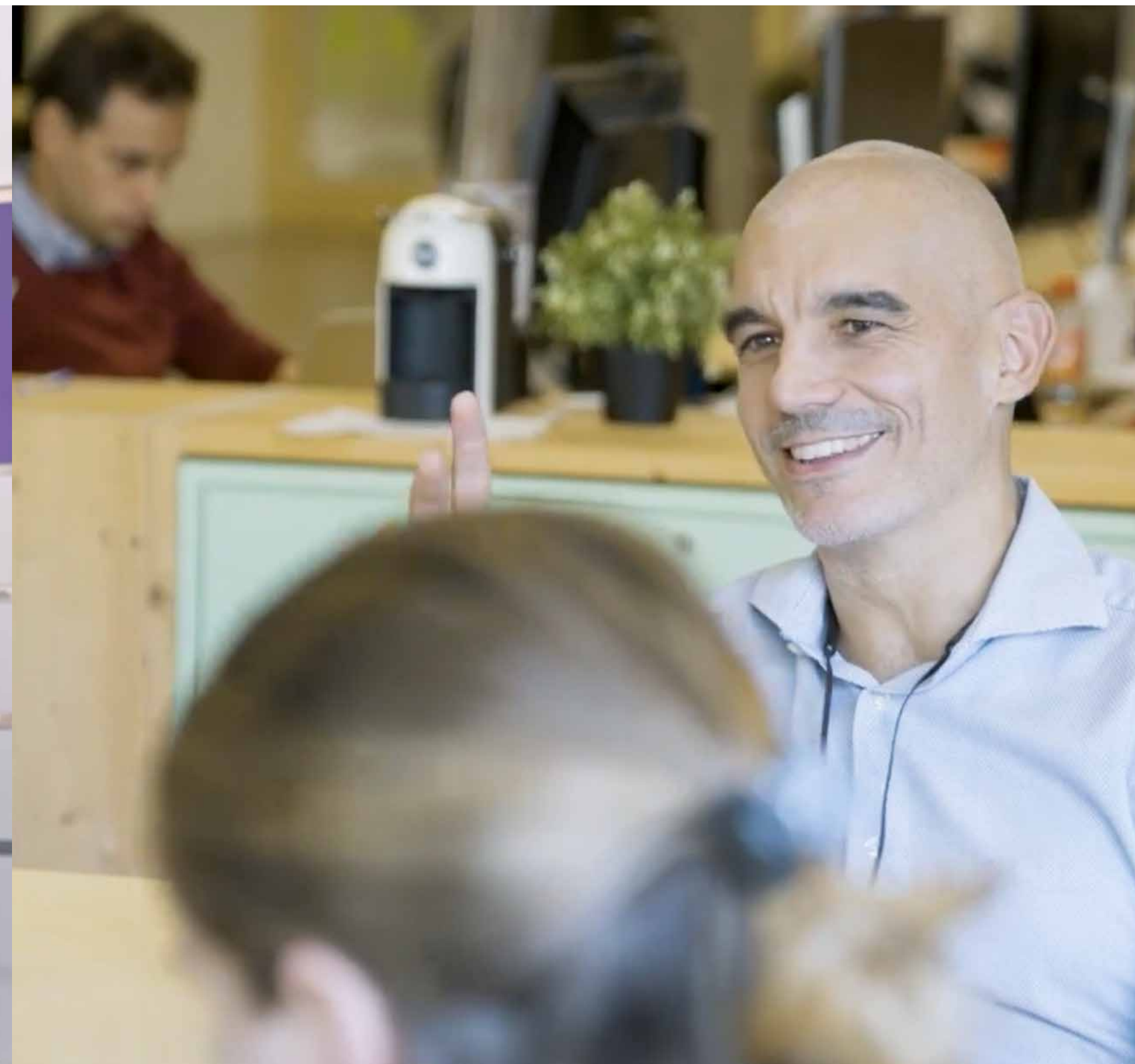
Make cybersecurity feel human without oversimplifying it.

We brought humanity to the forefront of the marketing, using authentic customer voices and real environments to build credibility and make complex technology more engaging and visually compelling.



Authentic customer voices

Real customers provided credible proof.



Human-centered stories

We connected technology to the people and problems it supported.



Visually compelling environments

Real places replaced generic, fear-based cybersecurity clichés.

VIDEO SYSTEM AT SCALE

Built for consistency, flexibility, and repeatability.

Consistent enough to feel like Cisco Secure. Flexible enough to work for different customers, stories, and channels.



Keep it simple, smart and relevant. Don't overcomplicate it.

When we say bold, we mean the idea, not the treatment.
Avoid using digital distortion and exaggerated color processing to enhance your photographs.

Keep your visual communications optimistic.
Stay away from dark, moody and dour imagery.

Avoid staged or forced images, especially of people.
Emotions should be authentic, not over-the-top. Avoid clichés.

Photography should be in full color.



Human, optimistic, & credible

Real people and real environments, without fear-based cyber clichés.

Consistent production language

Repeatable wide-and-tight coverage with clean, natural lighting.

Cisco Secure branding

Shared lower thirds, graphic hierarchy, screen treatment, and closing animation.

ONE GOAL, MULTIPLE APPLICATIONS

Make cybersecurity feel human without oversimplifying it.

Different creative formats solved different parts of the same problem: helping customers understand complex security technology.

CUSTOMER STORIES

Build trust through real-world proof

- Human stories connecting technology to outcomes
- Long-form films extended into web, social, nurture, Sales, and events



ANIMATED EXPLAINERS

Make abstract security concepts easier to understand

- Simplified complex products and terminology
- Used motion to visualize systems customers couldn't physically see
- Built reusable graphic and motion assets



BUSINESS IMPACT & SCALE

A repeatable creative system.

Scalable production model

Expanded output from roughly two to six customer films per quarter while standardizing the program and growing the team.

3x quarterly output

Expanded output from roughly two to six customer stories per quarter while growing the team and standardizing the program.

Multi-channel applications

Built a reusable content library supporting Sales, nurture, events, advocacy, and social.

Higher engagement

Customer videos consistently outperformed static and non-customer content in nurture and social.

WHAT THIS PROJECT DEMONSTRATES

Human storytelling + video production leadership + scalable systems + hands-on craft



Leading the on-site customer interview program at Cisco Live

How I lead creative

I start with the story, build the right production approach around it, and stay close enough to the work to protect the quality from concept through final delivery.

Strategy

Start with the business problem.

Systems

Build for repeatability, not one-off assets.

Collaboration

Bring Product Marketing, Demand Gen, Sales, Brand, and partners together around the same goal.

Craft

Stay close enough to the work to make sure the final execution delivers.